



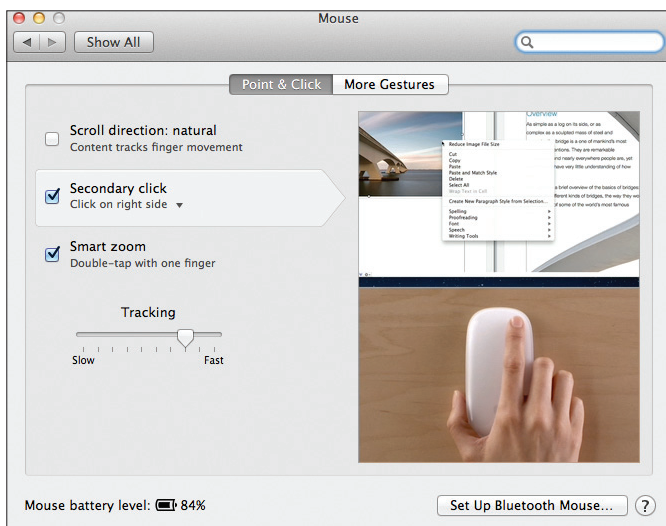
Oil in L.A.

Los Angeles is the third largest oil field in the US. Drilling goes on in plain sight, camouflaged by buildings <http://bit.ly/rqtz0R>

Bacteria in hail

Pseudomonas syringae is found in nearly 85 per cent of hail in hailstorms. They absorb moisture and increase the freezing point of water <http://bit.ly/ncPdh5>

Feature



Touch is a recurrent theme in the new Lion OS

the top tabs aren't glossy blue anymore – a regular feature associated with the older Snow Leopard's default colour scheme. The radio buttons are toned down and, overall, the interface doesn't distract. Also, the traffic lights red, yellow and green window buttons have gotten smaller in OS X Lion. The scroll bars – not vis-

ible in the Finder window – make the iOS influence plain to see. We prefer this new slightly colour-muted look of Lion's interface.

Apart from changing the Mac OS X Lion's login screen, Apple reinstates iOS lessons a little more forcefully by including a touch-enabled input device on every Mac it sells – whether it's the multitouch trackpad on the MacBooks or the Magic Mouse or Trackpad with the iMacs.

Touch-enabled devices were introduced in the pre-Lion era, but they become increasingly significant with Lion's out-of-the-box support for a slew of touch-enabled gestures. In fact, Lion mimics touch-input similar to an iOS



Scroll bars are hidden in Finder windows

device like the iPhone or iPad. While we're adept at clicking and gesturing on touch screen phones, trying to convince our brains to do the same on a desktop OS is a little difficult from the outset – an uncomfortable learning curve is necessary to enjoy the pure bliss that awaits at the conclusion.

The ability to resize a window from any of four sides and corners is a welcome addition to OS X Lion's user interface; we could never really understand why Snow Leopard and older versions of Mac OS X only limited window resizing from the bottom-right corner. In Lion, you merely



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